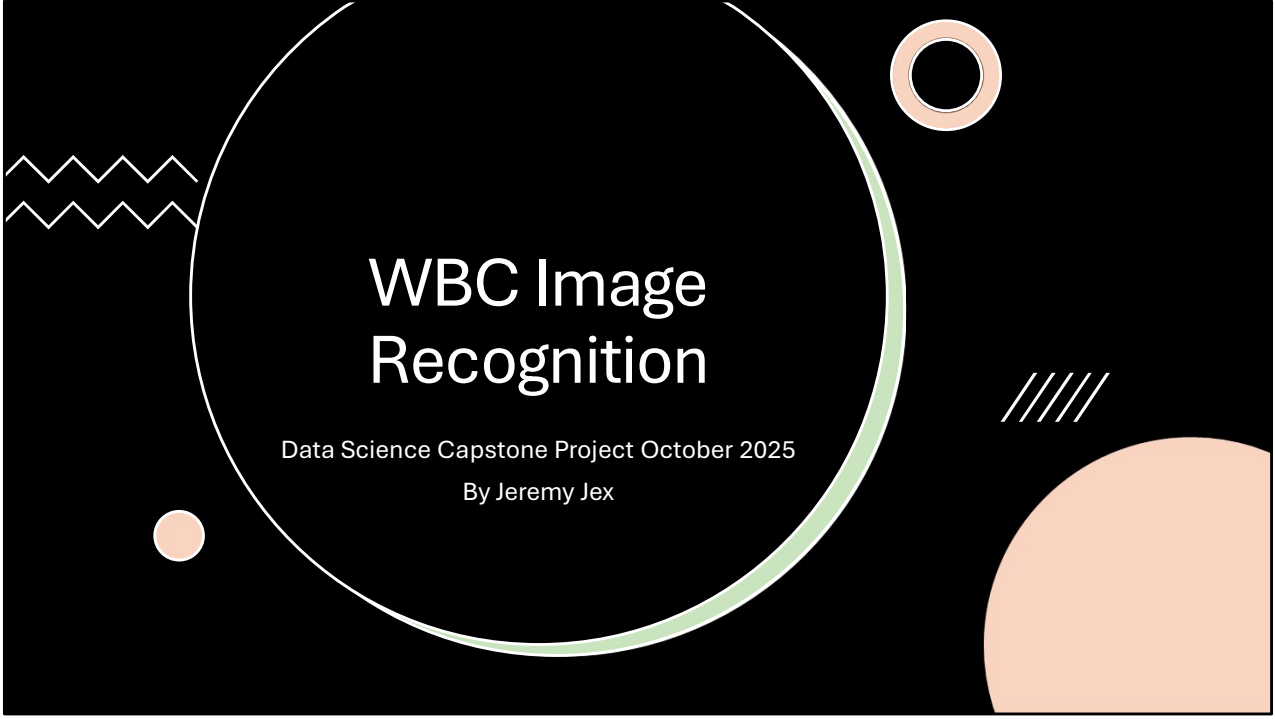
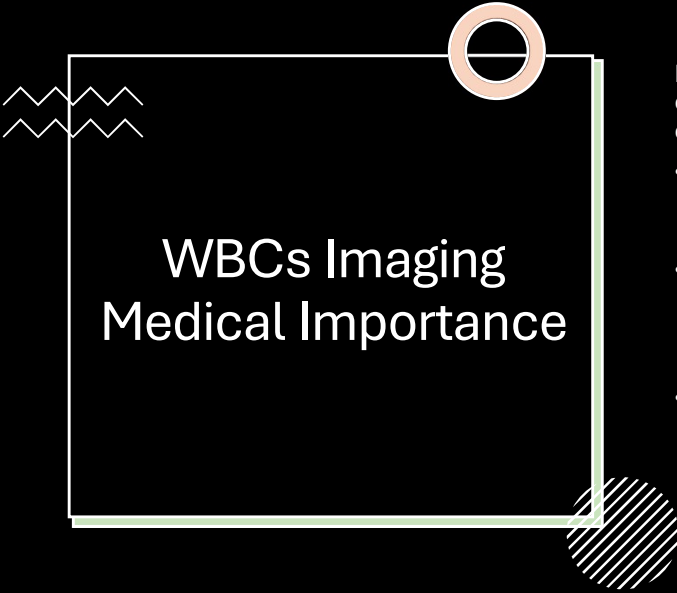




WBC Image Recognition

Data Science Capstone Project October 2025

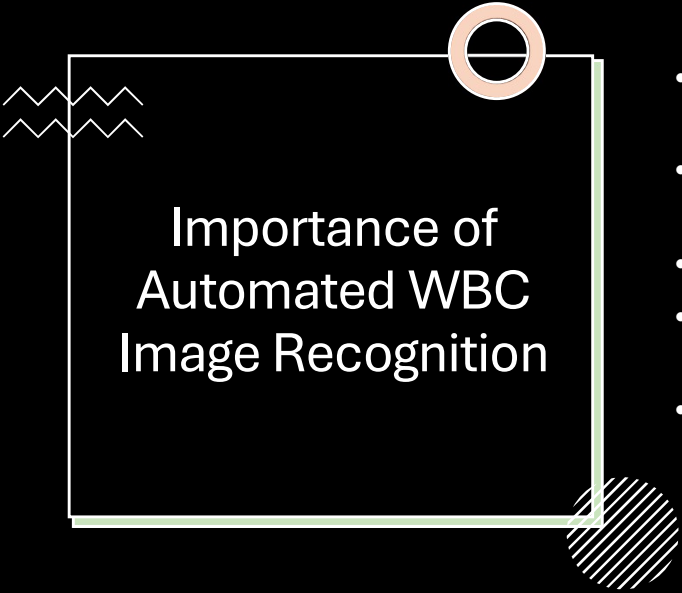
By Jeremy Jex



WBCs Imaging Medical Importance

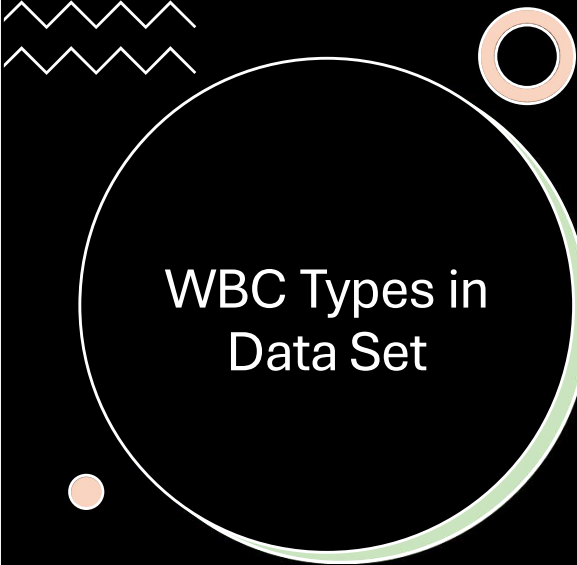
In Medical laboratory science white blood cells (WBCs) are used to diagnose medical conditions.

- A blood smear is prepared on a glass slide and then analyzed under a microscope.
- The laboratory professional then counts at least 100 WBCs to create a percentage that is multiplied by the total number of WBCs per volume of blood.
- This creates WBC absolute counts that are sent to the doctor to create a diagnosis. This process is called a manual (WBC) differential.



Importance of Automated WBC Image Recognition

- Medical laboratories are short staffed
- Automation allows lab staff to run testing simultaneously
- Faster turn around times
- More specimens processed with limited staff
- Faster patient diagnosis times



WBC Types in Data Set

This project looks at six types of WBCs:

- **Immature Granules**- These are precursors to mature white blood cells, and their presence indicates infection or cancer.
- **Basophil**- These are associated with allergies.
- **Eosinophils**- These are associated with allergies.
- **Lymphocytes**- These create a specific immune response by creating antibodies. They are also known as B cells, T cells, and Plasma cells.
- **Neutrophils**- These respond to general bacterial infections and nonspecific immune reactions.
- **Monocytes**- These WBCs phagocytize pathogens. They are also known as mast cells when found in tissues.





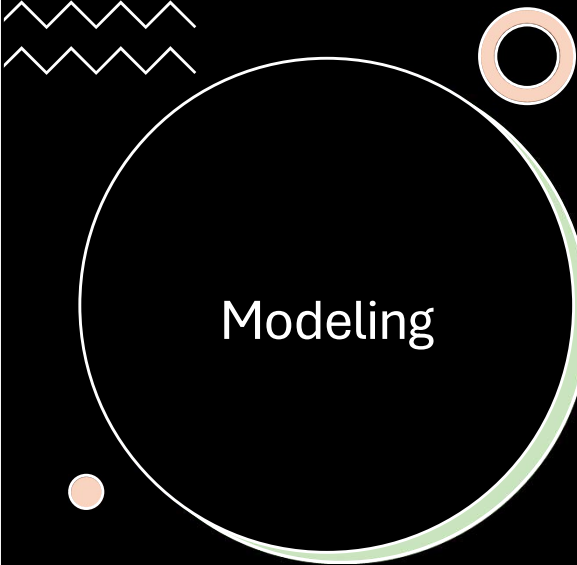
Data Set

- Kaggle Data Set
 - 17,092 CellaVision DM96 Images
 - Erythroblasts and platelet images were not included in EDA or modeling
 - 224 x 224 color pixel images
- 



Data Wrangling

- Cell types were confirmed to be labeled correctly
- Images were resized to 64 x 64 pixels
 - Grey scale and RGB image sets were created
- Images were made into arrays, flattened and scaled by dividing by 255
- Grey scale and RGB Pandas data frames were created using scaled arrays



Modeling

The following models were created.

- K Nearest Neighbor Grey Scale Data Frame
 - K Nearest Neighbor RGB Data Frame
 - Random Forest RGB Data Frame
 - Tensor Flow RGB Data Frame
 - Grid Search Tensor Flow RGB Data Frame
- 

Model Metrics

GRAY SCALE KNN	Precision	Recall	f1-score
Ig	0.52	0.25	0.34
basophil	0.52	0.45	0.48
eosinophil	0.4	0.84	0.54
lymphocyte	0.78	0.79	0.78
monocyte	0.43	0.55	0.48
neutrophil	0.89	0.31	0.46
accuracy			0.51
macro avg	0.59	0.53	0.51
weighted avg	0.6	0.51	0.49

RBG Random Forest	Precision	Recall	f1-score	AUC
Ig	0.61	0.8	0.69	0.42
basophil	0.75	0.42	0.54	0.67
eosinophil	0.88	0.93	0.9	0.35
lymphocyte	0.87	0.81	0.84	0.98
monocyte	0.87	0.39	0.54	0.95
neutrophil	0.86	0.95	0.9	0.99
accuracy			0.79	
macro avg	0.81	0.72	0.74	
weighted avg	0.8	0.79	0.78	

RBG KNN	Precision	Recall	f1-score	AUC
Ig	0.62	0.26	0.36	0.44
basophil	0.6	0.31	0.41	0.53
eosinophil	0.43	0.88	0.58	0.39
lymphocyte	0.72	0.84	0.77	0.96
monocyte	0.43	0.63	0.51	0.87
neutrophil	0.89	0.42	0.57	0.91
accuracy			0.54	
macro avg	0.62	0.56	0.45	
weighted avg	0.63	0.54	0.53	

Tensor Flow	Precision	Recall	f1-score	AUC
Ig	0.65	0.49	0.56	0.88
basophil	0.62	0.63	0.62	0.94
eosinophil	0.91	0.8	0.85	0.96
lymphocyte	0.81	0.82	0.81	0.98
monocyte	0.55	0.79	0.65	0.94
neutrophil	0.81	0.91	0.85	0.97
accuracy			0.74	
macro avg	0.72	0.74	0.72	
weighted avg	0.75	0.74	0.74	
5-k fold mean accuracy	0.6238			

Tensor Flow GridSearch	Precision	Recall	f1-score	AUC
Ig	0.79	0.3	0.4	0.91
basophil	0.44	0.84	0.58	0.95
eosinophil	0.89	0.93	0.91	0.99
lymphocyte	0.84	0.81	0.83	0.98
monocyte	0.54	0.9	0.67	0.96
neutrophil	0.92	0.83	0.87	0.98
accuracy			0.74	
macro avg	0.74	0.77	0.72	
weighted avg	0.79	0.74	0.73	
5-k fold mean accuracy	0.7881			

The Gray Scale images preformed poorly, so only the KNN model was tested on them.

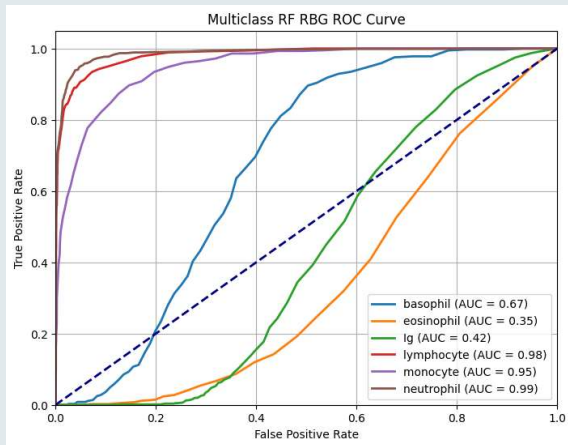
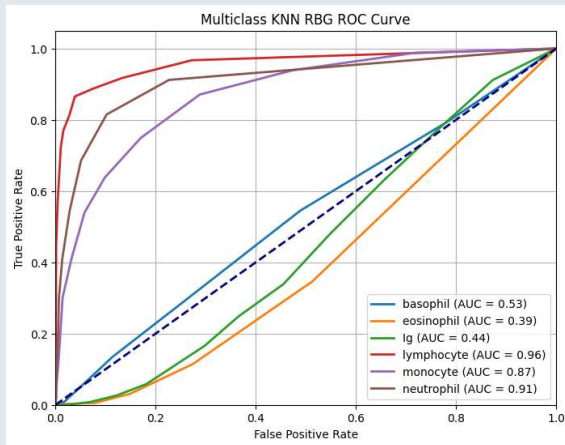
RBG KNN also preformed poorly, but better than the grey scale

RBG random forest preformed significantly better than KNN but had low AUC scores

RBG Tensor flow preformed will in all areas except 5-k fold accuracy was low

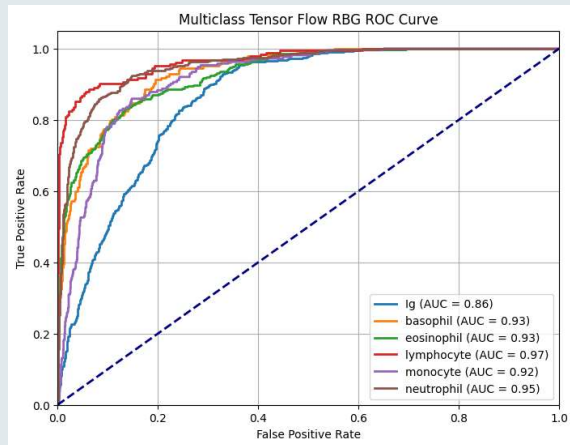
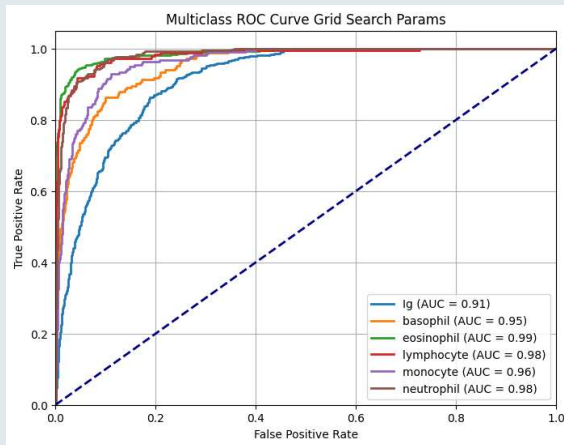
RBG Tensor Flow Grid Search preformed better with AUC scores and had a better k fold mean accuracy

ROC AUC Curves KNN and RF



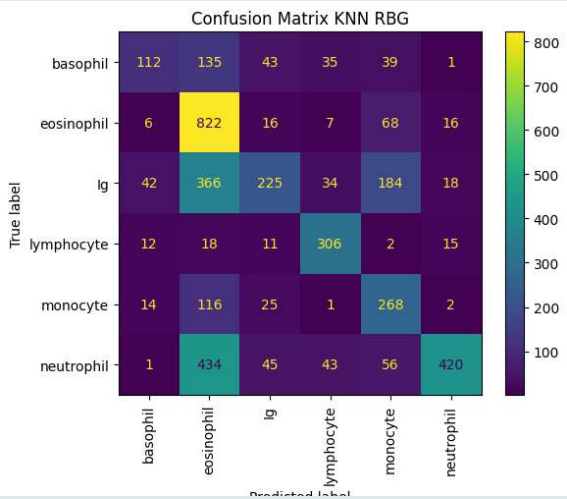
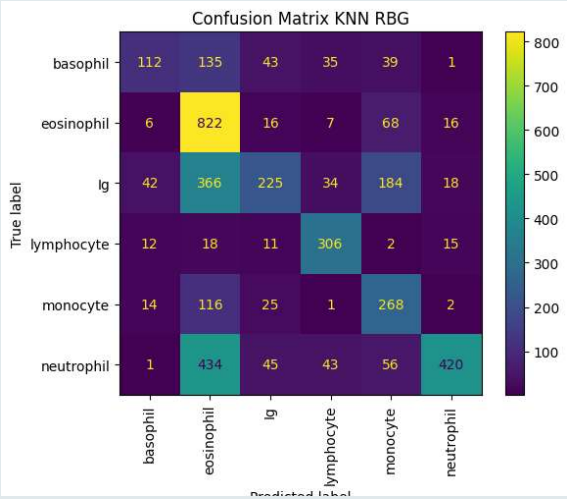
Here are the ROC graphs for the RBG KNN and RF models

ROC AUC Curves Tensor Flow



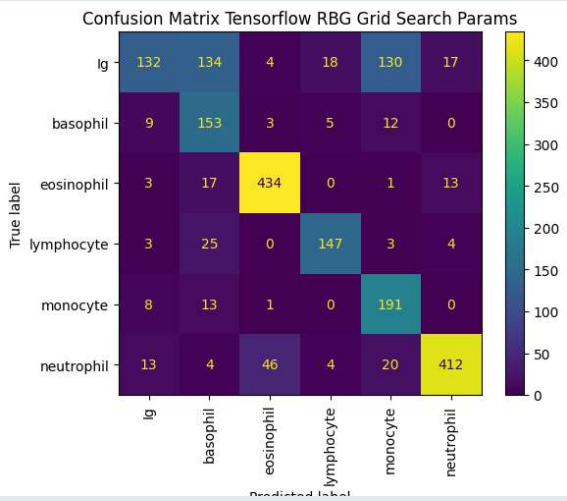
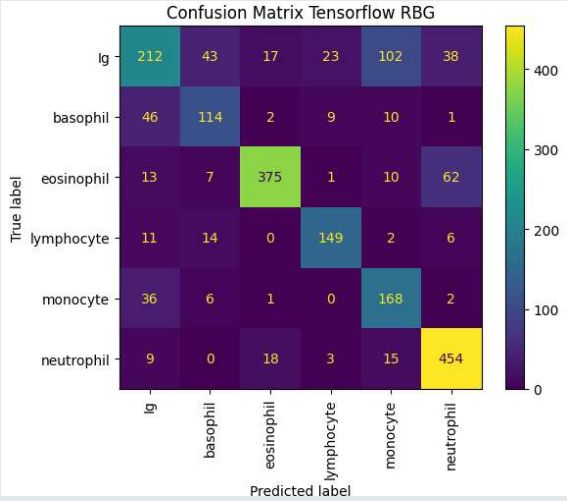
ROC AUC curves for Tensor Flow Models

Confusion Matrixes KNN and RF

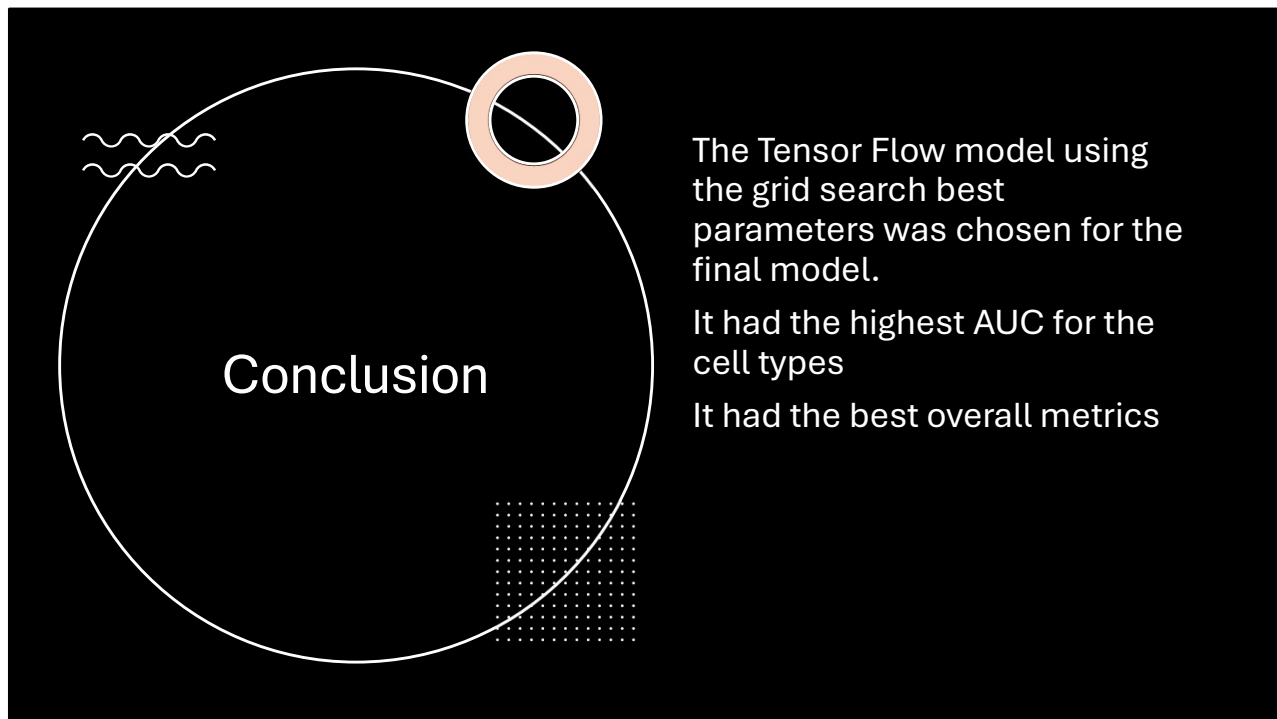


KNN and RF confusion Matrix

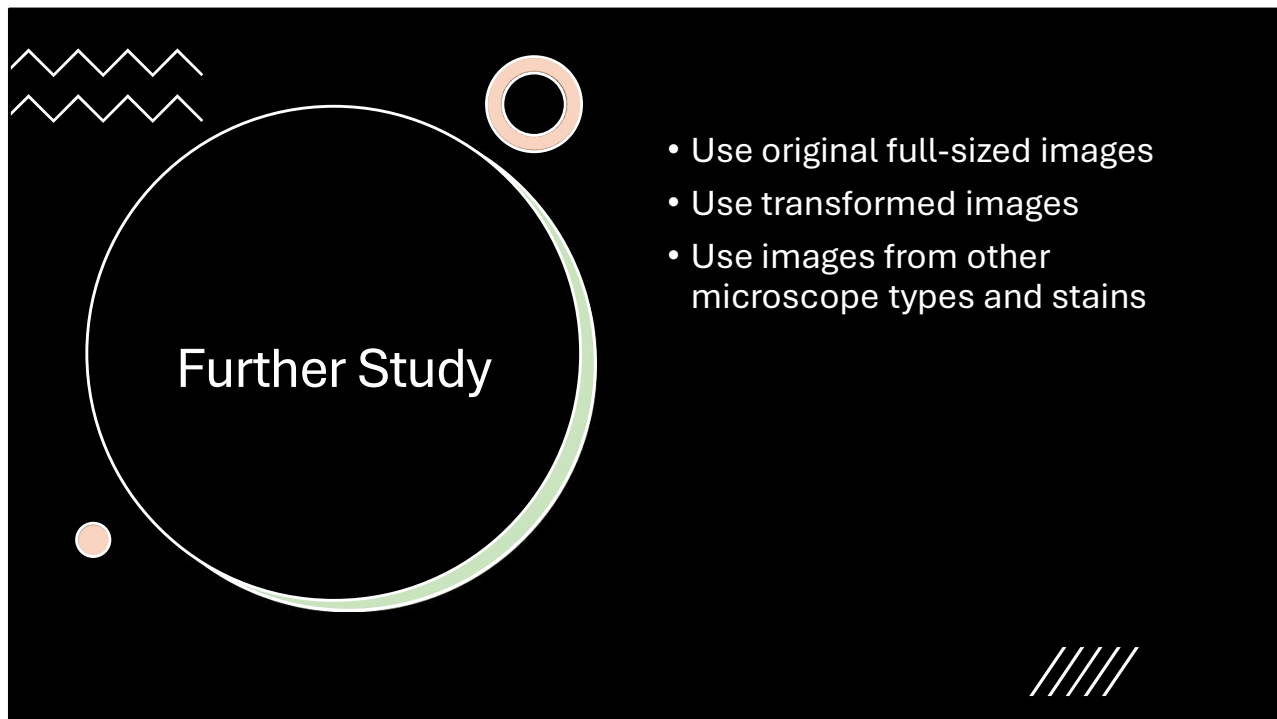
Confusion Matrix Tensor Flow



Tensor Flow Confusion matrix



The final model created from this analysis performs very well. It has high AUC scores across the six chosen cell types, and an overall accuracy around 0.79. Looking at the confusion matrix, we can see that the most misclassified images are immature granules. This makes sense because Ig cells are precursors to the other white blood cells and resemble their mature forms. Professional instrumentation also runs into similar classification issues and flags them for manual review. Current instrumentation has trouble recognizing the difference between Igs and mature cells. Also, eosinophils are sometimes typed as neutrophils. This is an ongoing issue in hematology analyzers.



The main suggestions for further research are to use the full-sized images (224 x 224) instead of scaling them down. Due to memory constraints this was not an option when performing data analysis. Using full size images may remove the discrepancies between Ig cells and other types. Also transforming the images in various ways to create a more robust data set could improve modeling.

Image sources could influence modeling too. Using images sourced from the same microscope camera, slides, and stain decrease sample variation. If this model was to be used for diagnosis it would have to specify the microscope, stain and slide types it is compatible with. The model could be more marketable if it can show accurate results when testing cellular data from other microscope types, not just the CellaVision.